

book. You'll be taken to a Gmail-like page that lists all your Notes, with the images in place.

Note that you can always create a note, whether in the little box or in the maximised view, by typing something out.

The fun part—if you can call it that—is that you can share your Notebooks (yes, you can have more than one Notebook—one for, say, each day, or one for “Work” and one for “Fun,” or whatever). When you share a Notebook, you enter e-mail addresses (which need to be Gmail addresses; if they're not, Google will send a kind invitation to the address(es) to create a Google ID) that will be allowed to collaborate on the Notebook. These people will be able to view and edit the Notes. You can also choose to create a permanent URL for the Notebook, which you can send out to your friends.

So, essentially, what the Firefox extension does is add an item to the context menu that lets you mark something as a Note.

Why you'd want to use this feature, and whether it's a useful thing, is up to you to decide! For your own purposes, it's better than bookmarking if only a certain portion—say a paragraph—of a page is of interest. And for collaborative purposes, you can imagine a wide range of scenarios: if you're a student, for example, you might actually take down notes from the Web this way, and your friends could see what you've taken down, adding their comments on each Note.

4.3 Google Music Trends

(www.google.com/trends/music)

The purpose of Music Trends is to see what people are listening to, based on the idea that Google Talk users represent the population at large. The information about what songs are at the top of the

charts, as seen on www.google.com/trends/music, is based on what Google Talk users were listening to while chatting using that IM client. Now in July 2006, Google Talk ranked #10 in the list of IM clients, with just 2 per cent of the number of users of MSN Messenger, according to Net traffic firm comScore Media Metrix—so we can't really that say Google Talk users represent the population at large. The fact is that this 2 per cent is still a large number of people, and besides, there's no reason for those people not to be representative, so let's just assume what's on Google Music Trends is indeed what “people are listening to.”

Here's how it works: you log in to Google Talk. As with other IMs, you can set your status to “Away,” “Busy,” etc. An additional option is to set your status to the song you're listening to right then! A song needs to be playing in a supported player—the latest version of iTunes, Winamp, Windows Media Player, or Yahoo Music Engine. And when you set your status to the current song, Google Talk gives you a message saying something like “Your status has been set to Hotel California: Eagles.” Then, a Google server will pick up this info. The Music Trends are calculated based on such information.

One might argue that the songs that figure on this list are biased towards the Net-savvy, because someone who isn't really isn't likely to bother setting a status this way. Another thing one might say is that light music (as opposed to classical music or classic rock) is more likely to figure.

At the page, you can click on some song titles, and do a Web search on some others. You can see the top-of-the-charts for a lot of genres, and for a lot of countries. When you click a clickable link, you're taken to a page with info about the song, a picture of the album cover, the song lyrics, where you can buy the song and/or album, and more.

Overall, this is just a place to discover what new music people seem to be listening to, not for music you already know about. And in any case, you could always do a Google search for the latest